



Rhyme Schemes & Poems

CPALMS Standards

ELA.2.R.1.4, ELA.3.R.1.4: Identify rhyme schemes and types of poems (free verse, rhymed verse, haiku, and limerick).

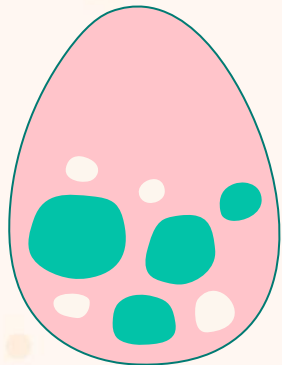


Table of Contents



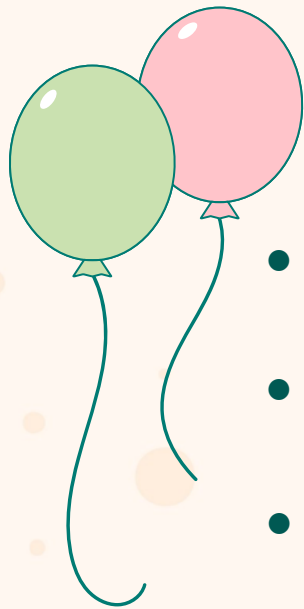
01 Terms & Definitions

02 Free verse poems

03 Rhymed verse poems

04 Haiku

05 Limerick & examples



Terms & Definitions

- **Free Verse:** poems without a strict rhyme scheme & structures; it depends on natural speech rhythms & creative line breaks
- **Rhymed verse:** series of lines that rhyme & follow a structured rhythmic pattern
- **Haiku:** a japanese 3-line poem with 17 syllables spread into a 5-7-5 format
 - Focuses on nature & a specific moment/memory
- **Limerick:** a humor filled, 5-line poem with a AABBA rhyme scheme & a bouncy rhythm

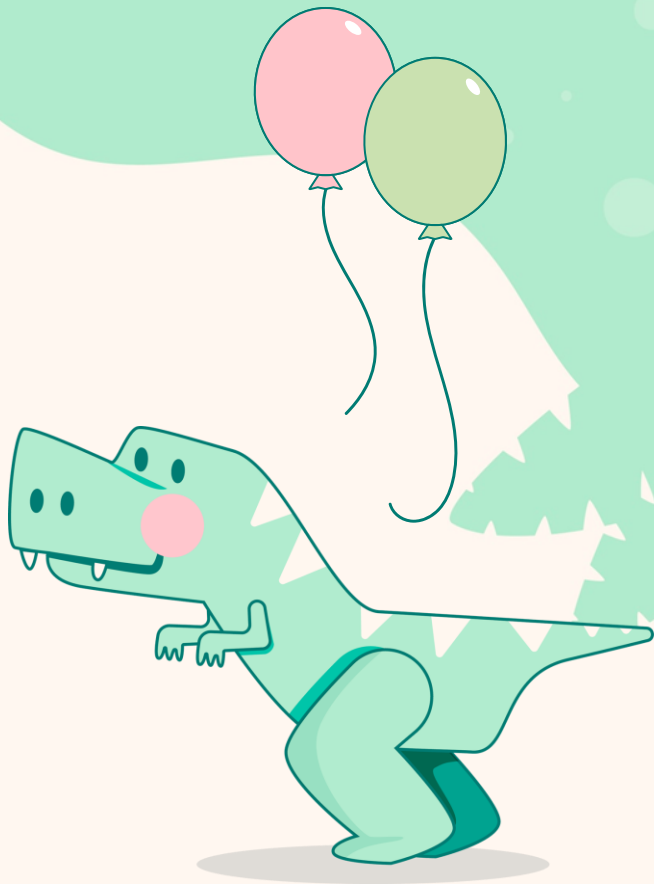
Free Verse

- No strict structure or rhyme

The fog comes
On little cat feet.

It sits looking
Over harbor and city
On silent haunches
and then moves on.

- What does the poem focus on? Maybe nature?
- What is the poem trying to say?
- Do you notice any rhymes or structure?





Rhymed Verse

When night came down and stars would
glow,
The dinos huddled, row by row.
They gave a roar—both loud and low,
From long, long, long ago! 🦖

- What is the difference between this poem and the previous poem?
- What do rhyming words do to the poem? Is it more interesting to read this way?
- What do you think the poem is talking about?



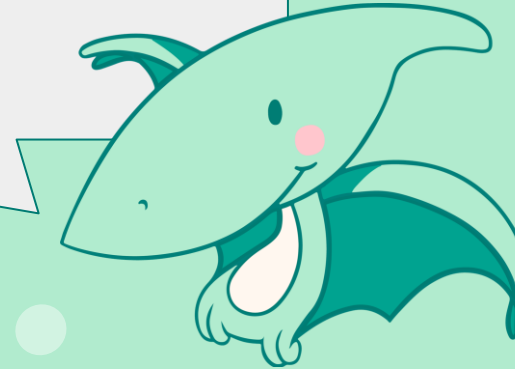
Haiku



- Topics focus on nature & a brief/quick memory

Bright sun warms my face
Bees buzz over yellow flowers
Spring wakes up the world 🌻

- What do you think is special about this poem compared to the previous ones?
- What is this poem talking about?
- How many syllables are used in each line?

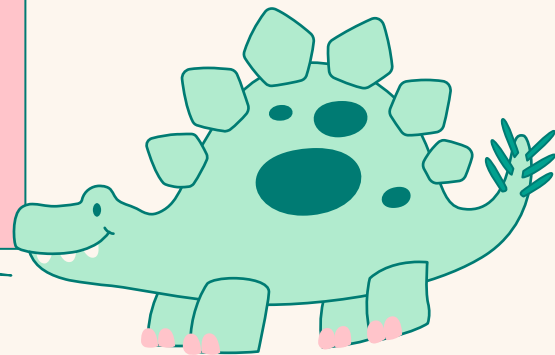
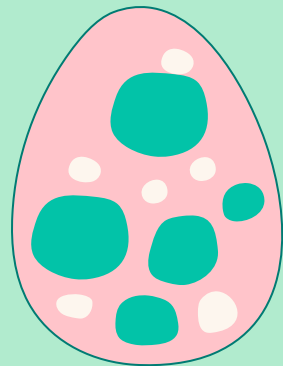


Limerick

- Think about humor

I need a front door for my hall
The replacement I bought was too tall.
So I hacked it and chopped it,
And carefully lopped it,
And now the dumb thing is too small.

- What words rhyme?
- What lines rhyme with each other and which lines do not?
- How could you change this poem to make it funnier but still within the guidelines of a limerick?



Out of the poems we went through, which one was your favorite & why? Try writing one and share it!



Examples



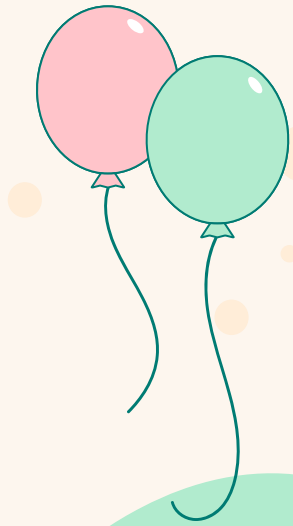
The wind came to visit today.
It tapped on my window
and whispered,
“Come outside and play.”

It pushed the clouds
like fluffy pillows
across the bright blue sky.

It tickled the leaves
until they laughed
and danced in a circle.

What kind of poem is this?

- 1) Free verse
- 2) haiku
- 3) Rhyme verse
- 4) limerick

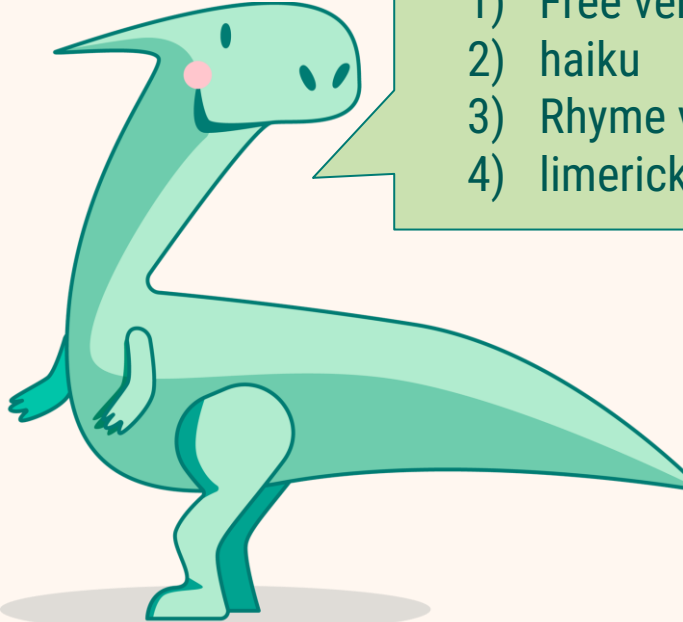


Examples

The wind came to visit today.
It tapped on my window
and whispered,
“Come outside and play.”

It pushed the clouds
like fluffy pillows
across the bright blue sky.

It tickled the leaves
until they laughed
and danced in a circle.

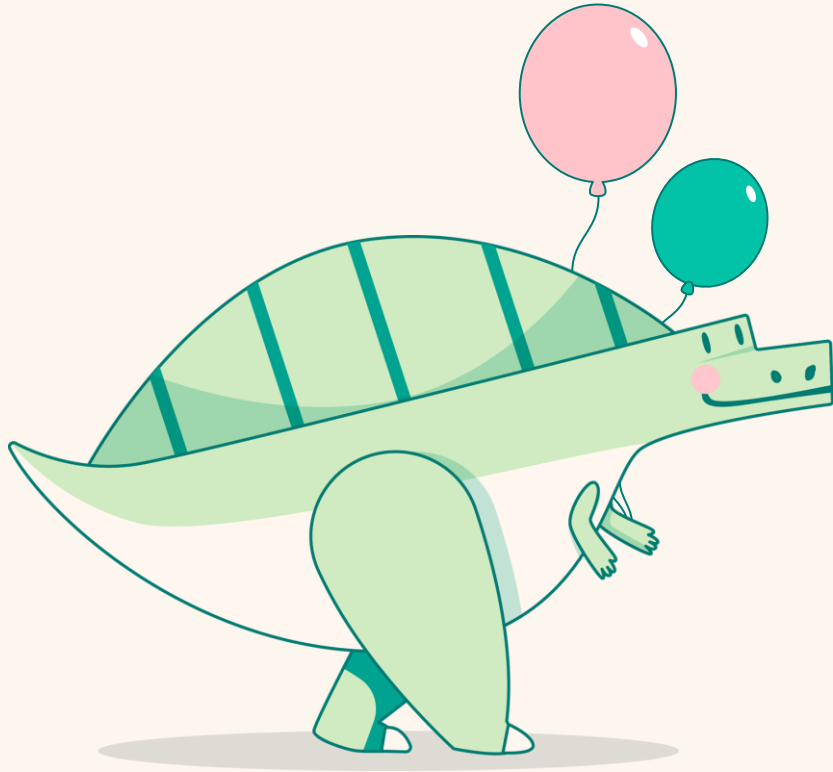


What kind of poem is this?

- 1) Free verse
- 2) haiku
- 3) Rhyme verse
- 4) limerick



Example



There once was a bee named Lee,
Who loved sipping sweet lemon tea.
She buzzed in the breeze,
Through flowers and trees,
As happy as ever could bee!

What kind of poem is this?

- 1) Free verse
- 2) haiku
- 3) Rhyme verse
- 4) limerick



What did you learn from this lesson?

- Does it rhyme? To many people, rhyme is connected to poetry but that is not always the case
- Which poem(s) did we discuss did not have rhyming words? If we added rhymes would kind of poem would it turn into?

Resources To Practice

[Poem Practice Worksheets](#)

[More Worksheets](#)

[Khan Academy Poem Practice](#)